

damage and be in a coma, after which you'll be hooked up to very expensive machines to help you live and breathe. Long-term care of the completely incapacitated costs a fortune. This is a very personal question, but one that should be discussed and answered as you begin to deal with aging family members.

3. **What kind of care do you expect?** This is a discussion that should happen years before its onset, preferably in your fifties, when you're at least a decade or two away from that inevitability. Because chances are, as you age, you're going to weaken, and you're going to need some form of long-term care eventually.
4. **Are you expecting to live with your children if you can't live independently?** If you're expecting to move in with them, you must discuss this now. Make sure there's a way to lift the financial burden if something like this happens. This might be the time to transfer wealth in exchange for long-term care provided by your kids. If you're fine with a nursing home, you should have that clearly spelled out.
5. **What are your financial expectations of family?** Do you expect your kids to foot the bill for some of your long-term care? I know a big Italian family who wanted to ensure their mother retired in relative luxury and agreed to pay for the very best the nursing home had to offer. There were nine brothers and sisters, all of whom contributed to varying degrees. They decided that everyone would contribute proportionately to their income. So the son with the successful chain of furniture stores paid the most, because he could, and the daughter on a fixed income paid the least. But they all paid something.
6. **What will happen when you're less mobile?** Does the bathroom need retrofitting? How are you handling the stairs? There will also come a day when you can no longer drive and won't be able to transport yourself to and from appointments. Make sure